

Power of Interest
DBS & Safer Recruitment Policy

Version: 0.2

Approved by: Alan Broad

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Purpose

Power of Interest is committed to safeguarding and promoting the welfare of children and young people. We believe that everyone involved in delivering our activities has a responsibility to create a safe, positive and inclusive environment.

This policy sets out how we recruit, appoint and support trustees, volunteers and staff to ensure that suitable individuals are involved in delivering our charitable activities. It also explains how Disclosure and Barring Service (DBS) checks are used where appropriate.

This policy should be read alongside our:

- Safeguarding Policy
- Code of Conduct
- Equality, Diversity and Inclusion Policy
- Data Protection and Privacy Policy

Scope

This policy applies to:

- Trustees
- Volunteers
- Staff (if employed)
- Session leaders
- Contractors and freelancers working on behalf of Power of Interest
- Anyone undertaking regulated activity on behalf of the charity

Our Commitment to Safer Recruitment

Power of Interest aims to recruit people who share our commitment to safeguarding children and young people.

We will:

- recruit fairly and transparently
- treat all applicants equally
- assess individuals against the requirements of the role
- carry out appropriate identity and background checks
- obtain DBS checks where legally required
- provide safeguarding induction and ongoing guidance
- ensure recruitment decisions prioritise the safety and wellbeing of young people.

Recruitment Process

Depending on the nature of the role, recruitment may include:

- completion of an application or expression of interest
- an interview or informal discussion
- verification of identity
- references where appropriate
- assessment of relevant skills and experience
- safeguarding declarations

- a DBS check where required
- acceptance of the charity's Code of Conduct.

Recruitment decisions will normally involve at least two trustees or one trustee and the Safeguarding Lead wherever practical.

Disclosure and Barring Service (DBS) Checks

Power of Interest complies with DBS guidance and will carry out criminal record checks where required by law and where appropriate for the role being undertaken.

The level of DBS check required will depend upon the responsibilities of the role and the level of contact with children or young people.

Examples include:

Role	Typical Requirement
Trustee with no direct youth contact	Normally no DBS required
Trustee involved with youth activities	Enhanced DBS where appropriate
Debate Leader or Volunteer working regularly with young people	Enhanced DBS
Designated Safeguarding Lead	Enhanced DBS with Barred List check where eligible

Volunteers Awaiting DBS Clearance

Where a DBS check is required, individuals must not undertake unsupervised activities with children until the required checks have been completed and deemed satisfactory.

While awaiting clearance, volunteers may only participate under appropriate supervision following a suitable risk assessment.

Identity and References

Where appropriate, Power of Interest will:

- verify an individual's identity
- request suitable references
- confirm relevant qualifications or experience where necessary
- discuss any gaps or concerns identified during recruitment.

Training and Induction

All volunteers, trustees and staff involved in delivering activities with young people will receive appropriate induction covering:

- safeguarding responsibilities
- recognising and reporting concerns
- the Code of Conduct
- health and safety
- equality and inclusion
- relevant organisational policies.

Additional safeguarding training will be provided where appropriate for the responsibilities of the role.

Supervision of Volunteers Without a DBS Check

Volunteers who have not received the appropriate DBS check must not be left alone with children or young people or undertake regulated activity. They may assist with activities only

when under the direct supervision of a DBS-checked member of staff or volunteer. They will not be given responsibility for the care, supervision, or management of children.

Confidentiality and Handling DBS Information

Information relating to DBS checks will be handled confidentially and in accordance with UK GDPR, the Data Protection Act 2018 and the DBS Code of Practice.

Power of Interest will:

- only request DBS checks where appropriate
- limit access to DBS information to authorised trustees
- retain only the minimum information necessary
- securely dispose of DBS information when no longer required.

Safeguarding Concerns During Recruitment

If safeguarding concerns arise during recruitment or following appointment, Power of Interest will assess the information carefully and take appropriate action.

This may include:

- seeking further information
- delaying or withdrawing an appointment
- implementing additional supervision
- referring concerns in accordance with the Safeguarding Policy
- making referrals to statutory agencies where required.

Monitoring and Review

The Trustees are responsible for ensuring this policy is implemented consistently and reviewed annually, or sooner if legislation or safeguarding guidance changes.

Any significant safeguarding incidents or changes in DBS legislation will prompt an earlier review.